

Yatra Foundation board. The governance framework is based on policies set by the Ministry of Civil Aviation, including data privacy policies under the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act. Regular audits ensure compliance.

Q: Is there any investment from the government or AAI?

A: The AAI has a 26% stake in the Digi Yatra Foundation, while the remaining 74% is shared by the five public-private-partnership airports. There's a separate governance structure with representation from the Ministry of Civil Aviation to ensure adherence to regulations.

Q: With private companies involved in running some airports, how is data shared?

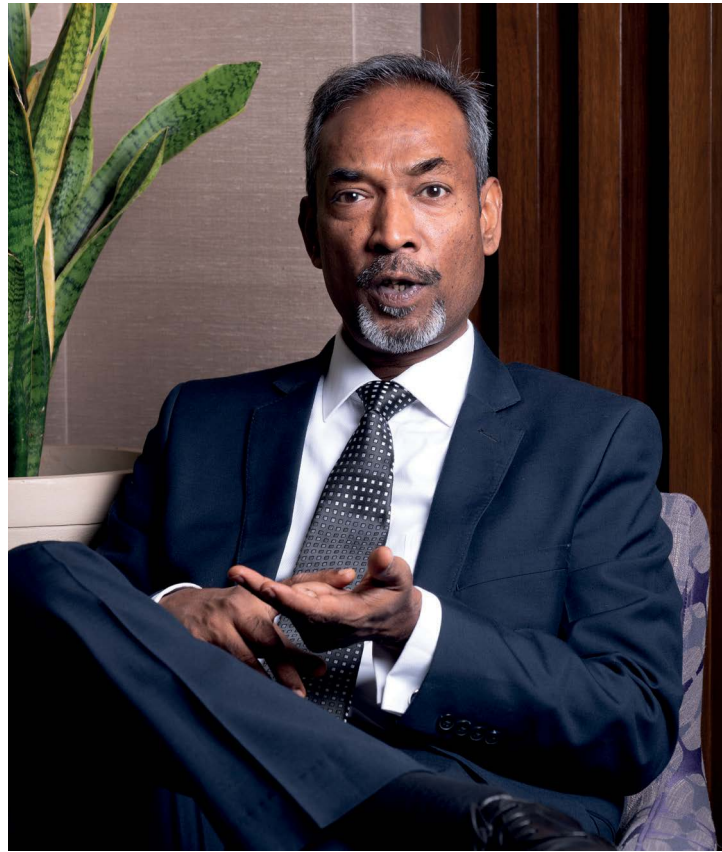
A: We've created a self-sovereign identity ecosystem, which means you, the passenger, control your data. The Digi Yatra Foundation itself doesn't store any passenger data. Imagine upgrading your phone. You wouldn't expect your new phone to automatically have all your Digi Yatra credentials installed, because that data isn't stored centrally. We made a conscious decision not to store personally identifiable information and risk data breaches. That's why we chose the concept of self-sovereign identity.

Q: How have you addressed privacy and security concerns and how does the identification system work? Will we see it at every airport in the country soon? Will there be any benefit to using this app for international flights?

A: That's a good point. Currently, we are operational at 14 airports, and we're adding another 14 in the next month or so. So, you can expect to see this at a total of 28 airports in the next couple of months. This will cover almost 90% of India's flying population in terms of addressable volume.

Now, regarding your question about international processes, I was recently at a major annual passenger terminal conference in Frankfurt, where I spoke about Digi Yatra's progress. There were other like-minded people working on similar digital identity concepts in travel. The whole theme was around digital identity in travel.

Interestingly, the European Union has already built a framework for digital identity and is now offering a toolkit for people to start testing and rolling out similar solutions. There are many pilot trials happening around the world. Obviously, I would like to see this working for international travel as well.



“Basically, we create verifiable credentials, and your phone has a [digital] wallet that stores the credentials”

We're in talks with the Ministry of External Affairs, the Ministry of Home Affairs, and the Bureau of Immigration. A tightly knit process needs to be established for this. However, other countries are also willing to partner with us on pilot programmes. This would allow someone flying a specific route to have a seamless process at the Delhi airport and then have their credentials already shared with the Frankfurt airport, eliminating immigration queues.

Q: Will you consider partnering with global tech firms or India's top tech companies?

A: Absolutely. As we scale up, we want to have a best-in-class solution provider on board to take us forward in this journey. **BT**

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